

Day 3 — Building & Validating Personas · Facilitator Guide

Companion to `labs/day-03-personas.md`. Facilitator-only — do not hand to participants. Cues, answer keys, timings, reflections.

Activity 1 — Persona Triage

Persona triage answer key:

- **Diana** = intentionally weak / demographic-heavy. Age, marital status, car, "busy, tech-savvy, loves efficiency tools," "wants to feel appreciated" — none of it changes a product decision.
- **Rita** = the model. Behavioral and evidence-tagged: observed retyping (6/8 ride-alongs), reported worst-hour (7/10 interviews), a named workaround, and an inferred assumption tagged as inferred.
- **Tom** = the trap. Mixes real behaviors (app check-in 60% of the time; "doesn't know where my truck is") with adjective-salad ("young, digital native, eager to learn new tools") and an unfalsifiable claim ("loves to be efficient"). Half good, half noise.

Make sure the room notices Rita — she's the one they should rewrite Diana toward.

Cues:

- Rita is intentionally good. If a triad doesn't notice, ask: "Which of these would you actually use to make a decision?"
- Tom is the trap — half good, half adjective-salad. Push triads to name the mix specifically, not just call him "mixed."

Activity 2 — Build Your Persona

Cues:

- Watch for triads using AI to fill Boxes 1–4. If they do, ask them to point at the source — the AI invented it.
- The "3 claims to validate" circle is the bridge to Activity 3. If they skip it, they will struggle with the role-play.

Activity 3 — Role-Play Interviews

Answer key / watch-for (hidden card details live in `week-01/handouts/dispatcher-character-cards.md` — interviewee-only):

- **Maria R.** — secretly keeps a paper notebook for truck stock because the app's inventory view is 3 clicks deep; dreads mid-day re-routes. Won't volunteer the notebook unless asked *how* she tracks stock.
- **Trey W.** — the confidently-wrong card. Claims re-routes "happen all day, ~10x a shift"; the real number is 2–3. Corrects himself only if the interviewer runs a memory-testing follow-up ("walk me through the last time," "how often *this week*?").
- **Susana O.** — repeats "same-day reconcile is the requirement," but the real bottleneck is payroll's Wednesday deadline, not dispatch. She works this out loud only when an interviewer asks *why* same-day matters and *what actually breaks* if it slips.

Keep interviewers from seeing Hidden details in advance — that's the whole exercise.

Cues:

- Trey's "confidently wrong" card is the most useful — many interviewers will believe him. Coach for follow-up questions that test memory ("How often does that actually happen?").
- The observer role is the most-skipped. Reinforce it as load-bearing — the tally is the artifact.

Activity 4 — JTBD Cross-Examination

Cues:

- Celebrate triads who drop a claim publicly. This is the hardest thing we ask all week and the most important signal of intellectual honesty.
- If a triad changes nothing under cross-examination, the cross-examiner was too soft. Coach the cross-examiner before the next pairing.